

SMART TREKKING GEAR: ADVANCEMENTS IN THE OUTDOORS

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In the last couple of decades, people who spend more time outdoors have been blessed with major enhancements in the technology of equipment they use. Would you believe that everything has become almost seven times lighter than what it used to be before? Let us look at all the equipment that is being used currently, which would not have been possible without the various technological advancements.



Smart camping tent (Credit: www.fishpond.co.nz)

Tents

In 1870s, tents had a waterproof canvas layer on top and an oil cloth beneath the floor to provide protection from wet snow. Both combined weighed up to 25 kilograms. Today, the tents weigh a little above two kilograms.

Tent poles are now made from aluminium, carbon fibre or fibre-glass, each of varying strengths.

Tents are powered by solar technologies like Cinch, which are fitted with 3500 smart lanterns. These provide luminescence rather than coloured luminescence.

Sleeping gear

Bedding for one person in a climbing team weighed about 10 kilograms in 1890s. This has come down to 990 grams (for -2°C to $+14^{\circ}\text{C}$ temperature range).

Sleeping bags are insulated with goose-down or synthetic fibres.

Clothing

In 1930s, most clothing and apparel was either made from leather or cotton, both of which are not suitable to insulate the cold from the hostile environment.

Today, we have gore-tex layers, which let the air go in but not water. This keeps the climbers dry most of the time, by taking out moisture from time to time.

Footwear

A few decades ago, leather boots were the only durable shoes mountaineers could use. Now with the introduction of gore-tex



Sleeping gear (Credit: www.iceland-camping-equipment.com)